
2026–27

FAFSA[®] Specifications Guide

Volume 1 – Summary of Changes

August 2025

**U.S. Department of Education's
Federal Student Aid**



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Acronyms

Table 1-1: Acronyms

Acronym	Definition
DHS	U.S. Department of Homeland Security
DOD	U.S. Department of Defense
DOJ	U.S. Department of Justice
EDE	electronic data exchange
FAA	financial aid administrator
FAFSA®	<i>Free Application for Federal Student Aid</i>
FPS	FAFSA Processing System
FSA	U.S. Department of Education's office of Federal Student Aid
FT Number	The FT number (also referred to as the FTI mailbox, FTI-SAIG mailbox, and Destination Point mailbox) is the number assigned to your institution when enrolling for the Federal Tax Information–Student Aid Internet Gateway (FTI-SAIG). An FT number is the identifier for the electronic mailbox that receives ISIRs with FTI data. It is a five-character alphanumeric string preceded by "FT," such as FT00001.
FTI	federal tax information
FTIM	Federal Taxpayer Information Module
<i>FUTURE Act</i>	Fostering Undergraduate Talent by Unlocking Resources for Education

Acronyms (continued)

Acronym	Definition
IASG	Federal Iraq and Afghanistan Service Grant
IDR	income-driven repayment
IRS	Internal Revenue Service
ISIR	<i>Institutional Student Information Record</i>
NSLDS®	National Student Loan Data System
OBBBA	One Big Beautiful Bill Act
PDF	portable document format
PSC	Program Support Center
SAI	Student Aid Index
SAIG	Student Aid Internet Gateway
SSA	Social Security Administration
SSN	Social Security number
SULA	Subsidized Usage Limit Applies
TG Number	SAIG Mailbox Number; a TG Number is the identifier for an electronic mailbox. It is a five-digit alphanumeric number, preceded by “TG.”
VA	U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs

Change History Table

The change history table below is updated each time the “Summary of Changes” volume of the *FAFSA Specifications Guide* is updated providing you with a cumulative list of revisions made to the document.

The footer is updated to include the revision date.

Table 1-2: Change History

Date	Page(s)	Changes/Notes
7/25	All	Volume 1 is released
8/25	1, 3, 6, 8, 9, and 17	Added a major change to describe the removal of the word “legal” from the online and PDF FAFSAs and the FAFSA Partner Portal per the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA). We also updated the <i>FAFSA Text and Question Label Changes</i> section under the PDF FAFSA® Form Changes and Enhancements for the following: - Revised label to “Question 14, Student State of Residence” and added additional details. - Revised label to “Question 33, Parent State of Residence” and added additional details.
8/25	8 to 10	Per the OBBBA we also updated the <i>FAFSA Text and Question Label Changes</i> section to provide additional details on the changes which include: - Added “FAFSA® Privacy Act Statement” - Revised “Question 22, Student Assets” - Revised “Question 40, Parent Assets” - Revised “Notes for Assets (Questions 22 and 40)”
8/25	15	Updated Verification of Identity’s description and availability in the FAFSA Partner Portal features table to reflect the implementation of the feature into 2025–26 and 2026–27 versions.
8/25	17	Per the OBBBA we also updated the legal residence question labels in the FAFSA Partner Portal.

Overview

What's in Volume 1, Summary of Changes?

In this volume of the *FAFSA® Specifications Guide*, we describe updates and enhancements to the FAFSA Processing System (FPS) and to student and school online products. We recommend you review the information provided in this volume, as some enhancements will require you to modify your office procedures and system operations.

The following sections are included in this volume:

- **Major Changes** – This section provides information about major FAFSA® Processing System (FPS) changes for the 2026–27 processing cycle and covers the following topics:
 - FAFSA Systems Availability
 - Contributor Invitation Solution
 - Parent Spouse or Partner Date of Birth
 - FAFSA Partner Portal URL
 - Renewal FAFSA Forms
 - Removed “Legal” from Question Labels for State and Date of Legal Residence
- **Summary of Changes to the 2026–27 Online FAFSA® Form and PDF FAFSA Form** – This section describes changes and enhancements for the 2026–27 online and PDF FAFSA forms and explains where to download the PDF FAFSA form.
- **Summary of Changes to the FAFSA Partner Portal** – This section provides information about FAFSA Partner Portal enrollment requirements and system changes.
- **Summary of Changes to the 2026–27 FPS** – This section provides information about changes to the U.S. Department of Education’s FPS. The following areas are described:
 - Corrections
 - Pseudo Social Security numbers (SSNs) and StudentAid.gov Accounts
 - Comment codes and text
 - Mailing addresses
 - *Institutional Student Information Record (ISIR)* test files

Unless otherwise noted, we are implementing the changes described in this guide in August 2025, at the start of the 2026–27 processing cycle.

We will describe enhancements implemented during the processing cycle in various future communications posted in the Knowledge Center at fsapartners.ed.gov/knowledge-center, including [electronic announcements](#) and [handbooks, manuals, and guides](#).

Major System Changes

Description of the Major FPS Changes

In this section, we describe other major changes to the application processing system and online products for 2026–27, including updates and enhancements resulting from annual and legislative changes. You can find policy and operational guidance in the [Handbooks, Manuals, or Guides section of the Knowledge Center](#).

FAFSA Systems Availability

On August 3, 2025, we will release the 2026–27 FAFSA form and ISIR processing for testing with a limited set of students and institutions. During this testing phase, we will launch full functionality, including submission, processing, and corrections. As testing progresses, we will make the form available to an increasing number of participants, starting with hundreds and expanding to tens of thousands of applicants. This approach allows us to test and resolve issues before making the form available to all students and contributors. The application will be available to all applicants no later than October 1, 2025.

This is the same approach used last cycle and was informed by conversations and feedback from thousands of students, institutions, and other stakeholders, who requested greater transparency and certainty in the development process and that the ability to submit, process, and correct FAFSAs be released at the same time. Throughout the testing period, Federal Student Aid will share regular updates to provide more transparency into our progress.

Processing of paper FAFSA forms will not be available during the Beta period that opens on August 3, 2025, but should be available no later than October 1, 2025.

Contributor Invitation Solution

The 2026–27 FAFSA form will introduce an updated contributor invitation process for adding required contributors to the form (i.e., parent, parent spouse, or student spouse). These changes include:

- Student and parent roles will invite contributors after they complete their own section.
- The system will generate an invitation code for students and parents to use to invite their contributors.
- Instead of providing contributor PII and contact information, users are only required to provide an email address to invite their required contributors.
- The system then generates and sends an invite link and invitation code to the email entered in the FAFSA form.
- To accept a FAFSA invitation, contributors must enter the invitation code, when prompted, after accessing the emailed link or logging in to StudentAid.gov.

Parent Spouse or Partner Date of Birth

A dependent student whose parents are married and filed a joint IRS tax form with their current spouse will only need to submit data for one parent. New this cycle, the parent must also provide their spouse's date of birth as it is used in the SAI calculation. To identify when the parent left the parent spouse date of birth blank, the FPS added a new edit that will set record reject code 69 and comment code 330 on ISIRs.

To resolve this reject, the Parents Spouse or Partner date of birth must be submitted as a correction. The FAA will be able to provide the Parent Spouse or Partner's date of birth using the FAFSA Partner Portal or by using Electronic Data Exchange corrections. The student can provide a correction online or using the paper FAFSA Submission Summary. No additional data updates need to be submitted to resolve reject 69. If additional Parent Spouse or Partner data is provided, the FPS will remove that data. Other corrections can be submitted at the same time if you are trying to resolve other rejects on a record.

If you submit an EDE correction to provide the Parent Spouse or Partner Date of Birth and the record doesn't meet the criteria, the EDE correction will be rejected for reason 20, "INVALID CORRECTION TO OTHER PARENT DOB" and no ISIR will be generated as a result of the correction.

When viewing the updated, non-rejected ISIR or FAFSA Submission Summary data, the date of birth will be the only piece of information in the Parent Spouse or Partner data block.

FAFSA Partner Portal URL

The FAFSA Partner Portal has separate websites with unique URLs for each processing year:

- 2024–25 (fafsa.partnerportal.ed.gov) – This cycle's website will remain active until corrections are shut down on September 13, 2025.
- 2025–26 (fafsa.partnerportal-2526.ed.gov)
- 2026–27 (fafsa.partnerportal-2627.ed.gov)

Each site requires FAAs to provide log-in credentials separately. FAAs will only be able to make corrections to transaction data for the cycle particular to the site they are currently logged in to and using. The websites for the 2025–26 and 2026–27 cycles will each provide a link that will take users to the other cycle's site.

Renewal FAFSA Forms

For 2026–27, prior year applicants will not have access to renewal applications. Renewal applications will tentatively resume during the 2027–28 application cycle.

Removed "Legal" from Question Labels for State and Date of Legal Residence

As part of the changes identified in the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA) that was signed into law on July 4, 2025, we are removing the word "legal" from the State of Legal Residence and Date of Legal Residence fields that display in the online FAFSA form, PDF FAFSA form, and the FAFSA Partner Portal. Additional OBBBA changes in other *FAFSA® Specifications Guide* volumes will be made in a future release.

Summary of Changes to the 2026–27 Online and PDF FAFSA® Forms

General FAFSA® Form Changes

The 2026–27 online and PDF FAFSA forms have been updated for the following changes.

- **Student Demographic Information: Gender** – To align with Executive Order 14168, Defending Women from Gender Ideology Extremism and Restoring Biological Truth to the Federal Government, 90 FR 8615 (January 30, 2025), the following changes were made:
 - We changed the question, “What is the student’s gender?” to read, “What is the student’s sex?”
 - We deleted the answer options “Nonbinary” and “Prefer not to answer” leaving the “Male” and “Female” response options.
 - This is a required field, and the student cannot leave it blank.
- **Student Race and Ethnicity** – To align with Office of Management and Budget (OMB) guidance, we made the following form changes:
 - Removed the standalone question, “Is the student of Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin?”
 - Relabeled the “What is the student’s race?” question to “What is the student’s race and/or ethnicity?”
 - Two new categories are added to the race and ethnicity list:
 - Hispanic or Latino – The subcategories are “Mexican,” “Puerto Rican,” “Salvadoran,” “Cuban,” “Dominican,” “Guatemalan,” and “Other Hispanic or Latino.”
 - Middle Eastern or North African – The subcategories are “Lebanese,” “Iranian,” “Egyptian,” “Syrian,” “Iraqi,” “Israeli,” and “Other Middle Eastern or North African.”
 - Reorganized the order of the race and ethnicity list.

Online FAFSA® Form Changes and Enhancements

This section describes changes and enhancements made to the online 2026–27 FAFSA form. Beyond the more general changes detailed in the Major Changes section and the General FAFSA Form Changes section, there are several more specific enhancements to the online FAFSA form as described below.

Online FAFSA Form Question Changes

- **Student Financials: “Student Spouse’s Information”** – The online FAFSA is updated to no longer collect Student Spouse PII when the Student is married and filed taxes jointly with their current spouse.
- **Parent Financials: “Parent Spouse’s Information”** – The online FAFSA is updated to only collect the Parent Spouse’s Date of Birth when the Parent is married and filed taxes jointly with their spouse.

Who Counts as a Parent on the FAFSA Form? (In-Form Tool)

Dependent students are no longer required to complete the in-form “Who Counts as a Parent?” tool (a series of dynamically displayed questions that identify the Parent contributor(s) on the FAFSA form) as part of the online form workflow.

Note: Students may still utilize the standalone tool on StudentAid.gov.

Role Permissions

The following roles can start an online FAFSA form:

- Student (Applicant)
- Parent (for a dependent student)

For an online FAFSA form to be considered complete, the student and identified contributors must complete their respective sections. Only contributors can access and complete their own sections. Students will only be able to review contributor section responses. Once the FAFSA form is complete, any role or contributor can submit the form.

Integrated into StudentAid.gov

The online FAFSA form tracks updates to the following integrated features on StudentAid.gov:

- **Status Center** – Contributors will no longer accept invitations from Status Center. A new FAFSA form page has been created for this functionality.
Note: Invitations to Student applicants will continue to display on Status Center.
- **Notification Center** – Notifications will no longer be triggered to indicate when a contributor has been invited to a Student’s form.

Social Security Number is Required

When a required contributor to a student’s online FAFSA form indicates that they do not have a Social Security number, then the system fills the Social Security Number field with all zeros. The corresponding Social Security field in the ISIR and FAFSA Submission Summary will include all zeros.

Legal Residence Question Label Changes

The following question labels were revised to remove the word “legal” from them:

- Student State of Legal Residence was updated to Student State of Residence.
- Date the Student Became a Legal Resident was updated to Date the Student Became a Resident.
- Parent State of Legal Residence was updated to Parent State of Residence.
- Date the Parent Became a Legal Resident was updated to Date the Parent Became a Resident.

PDF FAFSA® Form Changes and Enhancements

This section describes changes and enhancements made to the PDF 2026–27 FAFSA form. The 2026–27 PDF FAFSA form will be available later this year in the Application Processing Library of the Knowledge Center.

The FAFSA form continues to be available in both English and Spanish and comes in two versions: one for regular applicants and another for incarcerated applicants. (The incarcerated applicant version is identical to the regular version except for the P.O. Box return address and the header “Incarcerated Applicant Form,” which appears in the center of the header of each page.)

New for 2026–27: The PDF FAFSA forms are now 23 pages long: the first six pages consist of informational text, the next 14 pages make up the form itself (questions and answer fields), and the last three pages are the Notes section which provide help text.

FAFSA Form Design

The text font size and spacing of the Notes section was increased to improve readability; consequently, this section expanded from two pages to three.

In questions 4, 6, 12, 17, 19, 27, 37, and 44, we added lines between the main question and sub-questions. We also modified the line scheme in question 23 to match the scheme used elsewhere.

FAFSA Form Colors

The FAFSA form’s cycle color (used in the informational and help text sections, and in the Student and Student Spouse role sections) rotates between blue and green. For example, the 2026–27 cycle color is blue, and the 2027–28 cycle color will be green.

Each role section is color-coded for ease of identification. The Student section uses the cycle color, and the Student Spouse section is a lighter shade of that same cycle color. The Parent section is orange, and the Parent Spouse or Partner section is a lighter shade of orange. The Preparer section is gray. The Parent, Parent Spouse or Partner, and Preparer role section colors do not change across cycle years.

FAFSA Text and Question Label Changes

In addition to the changes described in the “General FAFSA® Form Changes” section above, the following changes have been made to the PDF FAFSA form:

- **Apply by the Deadlines** – We clarified that the applicant should confirm deadlines and application requirements with “the college or career school you are attending or plan to attend.”
- **Fill Out the FAFSA Form** – We updated the URL for language assistance to StudentAid.gov/apply-for-aid/fafsa/filling-out/other-languages.
- **Completing the FAFSA® Form, Who is considered a legal parent on the FAFSA form?** – We changed the “regardless of gender” to “regardless of sex.”
- **Completing the FAFSA® Form, Which parent should include information?** – In second bullet, added clarifying parenthetical text that reads, “(The parent who provided more financial support may or may not be the parent that the student lives with.)”

- **FAFSA® Privacy Act Statement** – Under the subsection “Opportunity to Access or Contest Tax Information,” we replaced the email address to the Office of the Ombudsman with a link to the feedback center (<https://studentaid.gov/feedback-center/>).
- **Federal Tax Information (FTI) Consent and Approval** – We added the following introductory statement: “The student and all contributors must provide consent and approval for their tax information to be transferred to the FAFSA form in order for the student’s eligibility for federal student aid to be calculated.” We also streamlined the FTI consent and approval language.
- **Student section instructions** – We clarified the introductory instructions to read, “All questions are required except in some circumstances (see “Can I skip any questions?”, on page 4).”
- **Question 2, Student Contact Information** – We added helper text to the right of the Permanent mailing address field that says, “If you are currently incarcerated, enter your inmate identifying number at the end of your permanent mailing address.”
- **Question 8, Apply for Direct Unsubsidized Loan Only** – We deleted “Apply for” from the question label so that it now reads, “Direct Unsubsidized Loan Only.”
- **Question 11, Student Demographic Information** – In addition to the new question label and answer choice changes as mentioned in the general form changes above, we also deleted the helper text for nonbinary and transgender students.
- **Question 12, Student Race and Ethnicity** – See “General FAFSA® Form Changes,” above, for a description of the changes made to this question.
- **Question 14, Student State of Residence** – For the “State” field we added helper text saying, “Usually, this is the state where the student lives while not attending school.” For the “Date the student became a resident” field, we added helper text saying, “If the student was born in their state of residence and hasn’t moved out of state since, enter the student’s date of birth. Otherwise, enter the date the student moved to their state of residence.” We also changed the question label from “Student State of Legal Residence” to “Student State of Residence,” and we deleted the word “legal” from the second sub-question label (“Date the student became a resident”) and from the helper text.
- **Question 17, Student High School Information** – We clarified the sub-question about state-recognized high school equivalents to read, “If the answer is ‘State-recognized high school equivalent,’ which of the following did or will the student receive, and what state issued it?”
- **Question 20, Student 2024 Tax Return Information (Amount of college grants, scholarships, or AmeriCorps benefits reported as income to the IRS)** – We clarified the helper text to read, “This question is typically answered with a zero because most of these items (including Federal Pell Grants) are not considered taxable income. If the student is married, include the amount their spouse reported.”
- **Question 22, Student Assets** – Various changes were made:
 - To the instructions we added the sentence “Net worth is the value of the investments, businesses, or farms minus any debts owed against them.”
 - For “Current total of cash, savings, and checking accounts,” we changed the helper text to read, “Don’t include student aid, retirement accounts, or investments.”
 - For “Current net worth of investments, including real estate,” we deleted the sentence “Net worth is the value of the investments minus any debts owed against them” since this guidance is now included in question instructions.

- For “Current net worth of businesses and investment farms,” we clarified the question to read, “Current net worth of businesses and farms,” and we updated the helper text to read, “Don’t include a family business with 100 or fewer full-time employees, farms where the family resides, or a commercial fishing business and related expenses.”
- **Questions 24, 29, 41, 46: Consent, Approval, and Signature** – In the Consent, Approval, and Signature question (found at the end of each contributor section), we increased the font size of the consent and approval language; lengthened the signature box; and added helper text below the box saying, “Handwritten original signature using full name is required.”
- **Question 33, Parent State of Residence** – For the “State” field we added helper text saying, “Usually, this is the state where the parent lives.” For the “Date the parent became a resident” field, we added helper text saying, “If the parent was born in their state of residence and hasn’t moved out of state since, enter the parent’s date of birth. Otherwise, enter the date the parent moved to their state of residence.” We also changed the question label from “Parent State of Legal Residence” to “Parent State of Residence,” and we deleted the word “legal” from the second sub-question label (“Date the parent became a resident”) and from the helper text.
- **Question 38, Parent 2024 Tax Return Information (Amount of college grants, scholarships, or AmeriCorps benefits reported as income to the IRS)** – We clarified the helper text to read, “This question is typically answered with a zero because most of these items (including Federal Pell Grants) are not considered taxable income. If the parent is married, include the amount their spouse reported.”
- **Question 40, Parent Assets** – Various changes were made:
 - To the instructions we added the sentence “Net worth is the value of the investments, businesses, or farms minus any debts owed against them,” and we changed “held by the parent and their spouse” to “held by the parent and their spouse or partner.”
 - For “Current total of cash, savings, and checking accounts,” we changed the helper text to read, “Don’t include student aid, retirement accounts, or investments.”
 - For “Current net worth of investments, including real estate,” we deleted the sentence “Net worth is the value of the investments minus any debts owed against them” since this guidance is now included in question instructions.
 - For “Current net worth of businesses and investment farms,” we clarified the question to read, “Current net worth of businesses and farms,” and we updated the helper text to read, “Don’t include a family business with 100 or fewer full-time employees, farms where the family resides, or a commercial fishing business and related expenses.”
- **Notes for Identity Information (Question 1)** – We added an introductory paragraph that reads, “If you have a StudentAid.gov account or submitted a FAFSA form in a prior year, enter your name exactly as you did for your account or prior FAFSA form. If you have changed your name with the Social Security Administration since then, use your most current name.”
- **Notes for Personal Circumstances (Question 5)** – In note for “Veteran” category, we removed “or were a cadet or midshipman at one of the service academies”; added “(military, naval, air, or space service)” after “U.S. armed forces,” and then added “served on active or inactive duty for training in the U.S. armed forces and were disabled from an injury incurred or aggravated in the line of duty.”
- **Notes for Citizenship (Question 13)** – We reworded the last sentence to read, “If you have a Social Security number but are not a citizen or an eligible noncitizen, including if you have been granted DACA, you may still complete the FAFSA form to determine eligibility for state or college aid.”

- **Notes for High School Information (Question 17)** – We clarified the note by adding the sentence “Only select “None of the previous” if the student won’t have any of the previous options when starting the 2026–27 school year.”
- **Notes for Federal Benefits Received (Questions 18 and 36)** – We added the following text: “Select ‘Free or reduced-price school lunch’ only if recipient’s family met U.S. Department of Agriculture income requirements. Don’t select it if they didn’t meet these requirements and only received this benefit because they live in a school district, city, county, or state that offers free or reduced-price meals to all enrolled students, regardless of income (sometimes called Community Eligibility Provision, or CEP).” Also, we added: “The refundable credit for coverage under a QHP is also known as a ‘health insurance subsidy under a federal or state marketplace.’”
- **Notes for 2024 Tax Return Information (Questions 20, 28, 38, and 45)** – We deleted the last sentence about leaving the question blank and added the sentence, “If the response is other than zero, the amount is typically not the same as the amount reported on Form 1098-T (Box 5) or the adjusted gross income you reported on your tax return.”
- **Notes for Assets (Questions 22 and 40)** – We changed all references of “investment farms” to “farms.” We also updated the guidance for what constitutes a business and farm for the purposes of reporting assets on the FAFSA form.

PDF FAFSA® Form Availability

While most applicants file the FAFSA form online, a paper application (PDF) option is still available. The PDF FAFSA form contains 23 pages (14 application pages and nine instructional pages). The PDF form is a screen-fillable PDF document that can be printed, signed with a handwritten signature, and submitted to Federal Student Aid by postal mail for processing.

Important Notes about Mailing a FAFSA Form:

- If your school is mailing a paper FAFSA form to Federal Student Aid for processing, be sure to include all application pages, even if the fields on a page are all blank. We must receive all the pages of the application in order to process the form. You do not need to send the instructional pages.
- Mailing the FAFSA form will require extra postage.

When the [English and Spanish versions](#) of the 2026–27 FAFSA form are available online for download, we will publish an electronic announcement with a link to these documents on the “Resources” page at [StudentAid.gov/resources](https://studentaid.gov/resources). You can also find the latest FAFSA form news and documents on the [Financial Aid Tool Kit for Counselors](#).

Applicants and parents can request up to three copies of the printed PDF FAFSA form from the Federal Student Aid Information Center if they are unable to download the online PDF version and print it.

We Value Your Comments and Suggestions!

Federal Student Aid continually seeks new and innovative ways to make applying for federal student aid easier and more convenient for applicants and their parents. Some of the changes we made to the online and PDF FAFSA forms in the past, were the result of feedback and comments we received from you. As always, we appreciate your contributions to improving our systems and processes and encourage you to continue to share your suggestions with us. We are particularly interested in ways to continue simplifying the online and PDF FAFSA forms by eliminating unnecessary data collection.

We encourage you to watch the Knowledge Center in 2026, when we will post an announcement regarding the 2027–28 FAFSA forms.

Summary of Changes to the FAFSA Partner Portal

Enrollment Requirements

To ensure your school can take full advantage of 2026–27 FAFSA Partner Portal enhancements at the beginning of the processing cycle, the Primary or Secondary Administrator associated with the SAIG Mailbox (TG/FT Number) used to send and receive FAFSA form and ISIR correction data should verify your FAFSA Online Services enrollment status on the FSA Partner Connect website.

Note: If your school enrolled for 2025–26, your enrollment carries over to 2026–27.

Annually, your school's Primary or Secondary Administrator is required to actively confirm the FAFSA Online Services for the users associated with your school's SAIG Mailbox number. If they do not perform this confirmation when requested by Federal Student Aid, your staff's rights for the FAFSA Online Services could be revoked, resulting in an error message when staff members attempt to access the site. We encourage you to monitor the Knowledge Center regularly for electronic announcements regarding active confirmation requirements.

If your school is not enrolled for FAFSA Online Services, your school's Primary or Secondary Administrator can complete the enrollment and select the 2026–27 FAFSA Partner Portal services for your school through the FSA Partner Connect website, located at fsapartners.ed.gov.

Note: The FAFSA Partner Portal has separate websites with unique URLs for each active processing cycle: 2024–25 (fafsa.partnerportal.ed.gov), 2025–26 (fafsa.partnerportal-2526.ed.gov), and 2026–27 (fafsa.partnerportal-2627.ed.gov) cycles. The 2024–25 site will remain active until corrections are shut down on September 13, 2025.

Each site requires FAAs to provide log-in credentials separately. FAAs will only be able to make corrections to transaction data for the cycle particular to the site they are currently logged in to and using. The websites for the 2025–26 and 2026–27 cycles will each provide a link that will take users to the other cycle's site.

All FAFSA Partner Portal users must have an FSA User ID and password. Your school's Primary or Secondary Administrator can enroll new users for FAFSA Online service. After a new user's enrollment is complete, an FSA User ID will be generated and sent to the new user in a welcome email. The email includes a link that will help the new user create a password and select challenge questions to complete the account setup.

Changes and Enhancements

In this section, we describe the 2026–27 FAFSA Partner Portal changes and enhancements. These features are available at system startup unless noted otherwise.

- Hyperlinks
- Features
- Applicant Information Unavailable to FAAs
- Requirement to Answer the Question “What is the student’s sex?”
- Parent Spouse or Partner Date of Birth
- Application Receipt Date
- Getting Help

Hyperlinks

The FAFSA Partner Portal has separate websites with unique URLs for each cycle year:

- 2024–25 (fafsa.partnerportal.ed.gov) – This cycle’s website will remain active until corrections are shut down on September 13, 2025.
- 2025–26 (fafsa.partnerportal-2526.ed.gov)
- 2026–27 (fafsa.partnerportal-2627.ed.gov)

Each site requires FAAs to provide log-in credentials separately. FAAs are only able to make corrections to transaction data for the cycle particular to the site they are currently logged in to and using. The websites for the 2025–26 and 2026–27 cycles will each provide a link that will take users to the other cycle’s site.

Features

Table 1-3 lists and describes the features currently available to FAAs in the FAFSA Partner Portal, as well as those that will be available in future cycles.

Table 1-3: FAFSA Partner Portal Features

Feature	Description	Availability
Applicant View	The FAFSA Partner Portal Applicant View displays after the FAA executes a search for an applicant with completed transaction results. Applicant View provides the FAA with a full list of the student’s transactions, allowing the FAA to select and review any transaction.	Startup
Transaction Selector	The Transaction Selector is a section of the Applicant View page. It displays the full list of transactions (up to 31) for the selected applicant. The FAA can select a transaction to review its details.	Startup
Transaction Review	Transaction Review displays the details of a transaction beneath the Transaction Selector when a single transaction has been selected to view.	Startup

Feature	Description	Availability									
Transaction Corrections	Transaction Corrections are displayed beneath the Transaction Selector when a transaction has been selected to correct from either the Transaction Selector or the Make Corrections button. It allows the FAA to correct any information in a given transaction, provided that information is visible to the FAA. See the subsection below this table for more details on applicant information unavailable to FAAs in the FAFSA Partner Portal.	Startup									
ISIR Request	ISIR Request allows FAA users to request ISIR records from the Award Eligibility Determination system datamart.	Startup									
FAFSA Submission Summary Paper Reprint function	FAAs can request that a FAFSA Submission Summary be printed and mailed to a student applicant.	Startup									
Verification of Identity	The FAFSA Partner Portal provides FAAs with a list of the students who listed the FAAs' respective schools on their FAFSA applications and who were selected for either V4 (Custom Verification) or V5 (Aggregate Verification) identity verification. In the Verification of Identity function, which is added for 2025–26 and 2026–27, FAAs can filter the list by Name or SSN. FAAs can also sort the records alphabetically, in ascending or descending order. In addition, they can filter the list to display all, display only applicants for whom results have not been provided, or display only applicants for whom results have been provided. FAAs can submit Verification of Identity results for individual students manually, or for up to 2,000 at a time by uploading a .csv file. See <i>FAFSA Specifications Guide, Volume 4A – Record Layouts</i> for the Verification of Identity .csv file record layout. Verification of Identity: Batch Upload Use this file upload option to submit Verification of Identity results only for applicants selected for V4 and V5. Files should be formatted as .csv Each row in the file should contain one applicant only. The row must have the following elements, each in their own column: applicant's nine-digit Social Security Number, Last Name, and Verification of Identity Result. <table border="1"> <tbody> <tr> <td>111223333</td><td>Davis</td><td>1</td></tr> <tr> <td>222333444</td><td>Thomas</td><td>2</td></tr> <tr> <td>333445555</td><td>Umbridge</td><td>5</td></tr> </tbody> </table> Up to 2,000 records can be submitted in one file. You cannot submit results for a student that does not have your Federal School Code listed on a transaction.	111223333	Davis	1	222333444	Thomas	2	333445555	Umbridge	5	Late August 2025
111223333	Davis	1									
222333444	Thomas	2									
333445555	Umbridge	5									

Feature	Description	Availability
Print FAFSA Submission Summary	FAAs will have the ability to print the FAFSA Submission Summary associated with the transaction they've selected to view in Transaction Review. See the subsection below this table for details on applicant information unavailable to FAAs on the printed FAFSA Submission Summary.	Future Release in 2026–27
Transaction Compare	FAAs will be able to select up to four student transactions from the Transaction Selector and compare them.	Future Release in 2026–27
Help	The FAFSA Partner Portal will feature a help text interface that will provide an easy and intuitive way for FAAs to access help topics.	Future Release

Applicant Information Unavailable to FAAs in the FAFSA Partner Portal

Reminder: FAAs do not have access to Federal Tax Information (FTI) submitted by applicants with their FAFSA form. In addition, FAAs cannot view a student's FAFSA form answers regarding race, ethnicity, or sex. This applies to information viewed in the FAFSA Partner Portal and on the printed FAFSA Submission Summary (available in a future release).

Requirement to Answer the Question “What is the student’s sex?”

The gender question was relabeled and the answer choices changed per Executive Order 14168. All student applicants must provide an answer to the student's sex question. If the student filed online they would be forced to provide an answer before moving forward, but if they submitted a paper FAFSA form they might leave the question blank. If the applicant did not provide an answer to the question, the FPS will reject the application with reject code 9 and comment 023 is assigned.

As noted above, the answer to the sex question is not visible on the FAFSA Partner Portal, so the FAA will have difficulty identifying these records. Also, the FAA cannot correct the sex question. To resolve the reject, the student must initiate a correction to provide their sex using the online FAFSA or paper FAFSA Submission Summary. Until this occurs the record will continue to be rejected.

Schools should be aware that we are adding messaging to the student's record that displays when the FAA opens the record in the FAFSA Partner Portal. The title heading “Missing Student's Sex” displays, and the message is “The transaction you have selected to correct is missing the response to the FAFSA question, ‘What is the student's sex?’ You can proceed with making corrections; however, the transaction will be rejected.”

Parent Spouse or Partner Date of Birth

As mentioned in the Major Changes section, a dependent student whose parents are married and filed a joint IRS tax form with their current spouse will only need to submit data for one parent *and* provide the date of birth for their parent's spouse or partner. You can provide the date of birth, if it is missing, using the FAFSA Partner Portal. See the Major Changes section for additional information regarding potential reject codes for not providing this information as well as correction information.

Legal Residence Question Label Changes

The following question labels were revised to remove the word “legal” from them:

- “Student State of Legal Residence” was updated to “Student State of Residence”
- “Student Legal Residence Date” was updated to “Student Date of Residence”
- “Parent State of Legal Residence” was updated to “Parent State of Residence”
- “Parent Legal Residence Date” was updated to “Parent Date of Residence”

Application Receipt Date

Coming soon: To help our FSA partners (states, schools, servicers) determine exactly when a student’s initial application was submitted, we will begin displaying the Application Receipt Date, which will include a timestamp on the Transaction Review page. Our partners may need this information to determine if a record was submitted in time for student aid deadline purposes. When the timing is close, this timestamp will help you make that determination with certainty. The timestamp displays in Central time, so if you are in a different time zone you will need to adjust the receipt time according to your location.

This will be implemented in a future release for 2025–26 and forward, not when the 2026–27 system starts up. The Application Receipt Date timestamp will not be included in the ISIR files for 2025–26 or 2026–27.

Getting Help

The FPS Help Desk is available to assist with FAFSA Partner Portal questions. The Help Desk email is support@fps.ed.gov and the phone number is 1-800-330-5947. You will need to provide the cycle and the transaction ID located in the Transaction Details under the Additional Processing Information section when sending emails.

Summary of Changes to the 2026–27 FPS

Overview

This section describes changes to the FPS. There were no significant changes to the agency matches, FPS edits, outputs sent to the students, or the comment codes and text. There were changes to the following components of the FPS:

- Corrections
- Pseudo-SSNs and StudentAid.gov Accounts
- Comment Codes and Text
- Mailing Addresses
- ISIR Test Files

Corrections

- **Parent Spouse or Partner Date of Birth** – As mentioned in the Major Changes section, a dependent student whose parents are married and filed a joint IRS tax form with their current spouse will only need to submit data for one parent *and* they must also provide the date of birth for their parent's spouse or partner. If this date of birth is not provided, the ISIR will be rejected for reason 69 and comment 330 is assigned. See the Major Changes section for additional correction information.
- **What is the student's sex?** – All student applicants must provide an answer to the question regarding the student's sex. If the student filed online, they would be forced to provide an answer before moving forward, but if they submitted a paper FAFSA form, they might leave the question blank. If the applicant did not provide an answer to the question, the FPS will reject the application with reject code 9 and comment 023 is assigned.

It is important to note that the answer to the sex question is not included in the ISIR, so the FAA will have difficulty identifying these records. Also, the FAA cannot correct the sex question. To resolve the reject, the student must initiate a correction to provide their sex using the online FAFSA or paper FAFSA Submission Summary. Until this occurs the record will continue to be rejected.

We are adding messaging to the student's record that displays when the FAA opens their record in the FAFSA Partner Portal.

Pseudo-SSNs and StudentAid.gov Accounts

Pseudo-SSNs are for applicants who do not have an SSN and whose state of residence is one of the Freely Associated States. Pseudo-SSNs are assigned to students only. If an applicant has previously been assigned a pseudo-SSN starting with “666” or “000,” they should continue to use it. Returning applicants who complete the online FAFSA form do not need to enter their pseudo-SSN when they complete the form. The number is automatically associated with their FAFSA form when they log in with their StudentAid.gov account, and the pseudo-SSN value will remain the same for upcoming cycles. Returning applicants who complete the paper FAFSA form are instructed to enter their previously assigned pseudo-SSN. When the FPS assigns an applicant a pseudo-SSN in 2026–27, it will begin with “000-27.”

Reminders:

- A student’s spouse or their parent will not need a pseudo-SSN and will not be issued a pseudo-SSN; on the online FAFSA form, the SSN field for the student spouse or parent will be disabled, and in the PDF they will continue to enter all zeros for their SSN. However, if a student with a pseudo-SSN is a contributor on a different FAFSA form, their pseudo-SSN will be populated into their corresponding contributor SSN field.
- Each contributor for an online FAFSA form must have a StudentAid.gov account to provide information. Applicants and contributors who do not have an SSN can now request a StudentAid.gov account. Their information will be sent through a new matching process.

Social Security Number is Required

When a required contributor to a student’s online FAFSA form indicates that they do not have a Social Security number, then the system fills the Social Security Number field with all zeros. If a PDF FAFSA form is filled out and submitted for processing the applicant’s contributor is directed to enter all zeros if they do not have a Social Security number. The corresponding Social Security field in the ISIR and FAFSA Submission Summary will include all zeros.

Comment Codes and Text

Comments appear on the paper FAFSA Submission Summary that we mail to applicants and on the electronic FAFSA Submission Summary that applicants view online. For a full listing of the 2026–27 comment numbers, comment text, and comment resolutions, see the *FAFSA Specifications Guide, Volume 7 – Comment Codes*. Changes to the comment text and actions can be identified in the “Notes” column of the 2026–27 Comment Text table.

Mailing Addresses

All regular FAFSA forms and FAFSA Submission Summaries for 2026–27 will be sent to one mailbox number, regardless of the language of the form. Likewise, all incarcerated FAFSA forms and FAFSA Submission Summaries, regardless of language, will be sent to one mailbox.

Table 1-4: FAFSA Form Mailing Addresses

Type of Form	Address
Regular Applicants FAFSA Applications (Paper) and FAFSA Submission Summary English and Spanish	Federal Student Aid Programs P.O. Box 70204 London, KY 40742-0204
Incarcerated Applicants FAFSA Applications (Paper) and FAFSA Submission Summary English and Spanish	Federal Student Aid Programs P.O. Box 70205 London, KY 40742-0205
COPPA Applicants FAFSA Applications (Paper) and FAFSA Submission Summary English and Spanish	Federal Student Aid Programs Attn: COPPA Process 25 Air Park Drive London, KY 40744-8236
Documents Received in Error If you receive student documents in error, promptly return the documents along with the original packaging to the PSC with a note explaining the reason for return.	Federal Student Aid Programs P.O. Box 70207 London, KY 40742-0207

ISIR Test Files

The 2026–27 Test system includes simulated ISIR data that you can download for testing with your student aid system. Testing is optional; the Department of Education does not require it. The test ISIR data is a tool for you to use to help ensure that your processing system is prepared for the ISIR data produced by the FPS. Federal Student aid will post an electronic announcement on the Knowledge Center when the ISIR test file is available. For additional testing information, see the *FAFSA Specifications Guide, Volume 9 – Testing and Web Demo System*.